

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 690

By Crowe

A RESOLUTION to honor Dr. Randy Wykoff, Dean of the College of Public Health at East Tennessee State University, on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of industry; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Randy Wykoff is one such estimable person, who has served with distinction as the founding dean of the College of Public Health at East Tennessee State University (ETSU); and

WHEREAS, in addition to serving as the founding dean of ETSU's College of Public Health, Dr. Wykoff also serves as the co-director of the Center for Rural Health Research at ETSU; and

WHEREAS, after a distinguished career, Dr. Randy Wykoff recently announced that he will be taking a much-deserved retirement after the semester ends in May 2026; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Randy Wykoff is a board-certified physician in both pediatrics and preventive medicine, with additional certification in tropical medicine; he holds four degrees from Tulane University, including the doctor of medicine, master of public health in tropical medicine, bachelor of science, and bachelor of arts. He completed a residency in pediatrics at the University of Virginia and a residency in preventive medicine through the department of tropical medicine at Tulane; and

WHEREAS, prior to entering academia, Dr. Wykoff served as senior vice president for International Operations at Project HOPE and enjoyed an illustrious tenure with the federal government as deputy assistant secretary for health at the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services; and

WHEREAS, while working for the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, he was awarded the Surgeon General's Medallion, the highest civilian honor in the U.S. Public Health Service. He also held positions with the Food and Drug Administration as associate commissioner for operations and associate commissioner for AIDS and Special Health Issues; and

WHEREAS, prior to joining the federal government, Dr. Wykoff was responsible for overseeing all public health activities in a rural six-county area of South Carolina; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Wykoff's research has been published in numerous journals, including the *Journal of the American Medical Association*, *The New England Journal of Medicine*, *Southern Medical Journal*, and the *Journal of the International Association of Physicians in AIDS Care*; and

WHEREAS, a 2022 inductee in the Tennessee Health Care Hall of Fame, Dr. Randy Wykoff also co-edited the award-winning book *Appalachian Health: Culture, Challenges, and Capacity*, which explores the health issues and challenges facing the people of Appalachia; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Randy Wykoff exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Dr. Randy Wykoff has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his colleagues, his students, and the good people of the State of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we extend to Dr. Randy Wykoff our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.